

Vibe Coding Hackathon

Challenge Brief

30 April 2026

Overview

The Vibe Coding Hackathon is a one-day, individual sprint focused on rapid prototyping using AI-assisted development tools. The goal is to build a functional, user-facing application with minimal manual code changes — leaning into Claude Code, free-tier frontend generators, and your own creativity. This challenge is about flow: move fast, iterate often, and let the tools do the heavy lifting. You are judged not just on what you build, but on how well you leverage AI to get there.

Prerequisites

Tools & Access

- Claude Code — primary development assistant (required)
- Any public free-tier frontend code generator (e.g., v0.dev, Bolt.new, Lovable, etc.)
- Git & GitHub — all code must be committed to a repository
- Anthropic / OpenAI / Internal AI API Keys (provided or personal free tier)
- VS Code or any preferred code editor (AI copilot plugins are allowed this time)

Participation

- Individual challenge — each participant works independently
- Discussion and ideation with others is encouraged; code must be yours
- Each participant selects one problem statement (PS 3 is open-ended)

What is Vibe Coding?

Vibe coding means using AI as your primary coding partner. You describe what you want, the AI generates the code, and your job is to guide, review, and steer — not write every line yourself. The expectation for this challenge is:

- Minimal manual code changes — let Claude Code and generators do the work
- Document AI prompts used in your README to show your process (optional)
- Focus your energy on product thinking, UX decisions, and iteration speed

Problem Statements

PS 1: Research Paper Explorer

Description

Build an interactive web interface that allows users to explore, browse, and discover academic research papers. Users should be able to search, filter, and view paper summaries in a clean, intuitive UI. The focus is on the frontend experience and seamless AI-powered content presentation.

PS 2: Citation Helper Interface

Description

Create a web tool that helps researchers and authors manage and format citations. Users should be able to paste a paper title or DOI and get back a formatted citation in multiple styles (APA, MLA, Chicago). Bonus: detect and flag potential citation issues or duplicates.

PS 3 (Open): Open Innovation — Taylor & Francis Theme

Description

Build anything that could be genuinely useful for Taylor & Francis — researchers, editors, authors, or readers. This is your creative brief. The only constraint is that it must be relevant to academic publishing, research workflows, or knowledge discovery. Think about pain points you have observed or experienced.

Rules & Guidelines

Permitted

- Claude Code as your primary development tool (required)
- Any public free-tier frontend generator (v0.dev, Bolt.new, Lovable, etc.)
- AI copilot plugins in IDEs are allowed for this challenge
- Open-source libraries, pre-trained models, and public APIs
- Discussion and ideation with other participants (code must remain individual)

Not Permitted

- Submitting another participant's code or a pre-built project
- Use of proprietary datasets or paid APIs not pre-approved
- Minimal effort submissions — the prototype must be functional and demonstrable

Deliverables

- Working prototype — must run end-to-end and be demoed live
- GitHub repository with commit history and a README (optional)
- 5-minute demo on 4th May followed by a 3-minute Q&A

Vibe it. Ship it. Demo it.